

office of chancellor, and the archbishop elect proceeded to the Roman court, where, notwithstanding the king's letters, the pontiff detained him till January 6, 1306, before he granted him consecration; and then only on the payment of 9500 marks. To relieve him from the poverty resulting from so extortionate an imposition, the clergy of his province raised the money among them by benevolence and subsidy.

The ten years of his rule were principally illustrated by his support of the knights templars in their fallen fortunes: and by his assisting at the general council held at Vienne, in 1311, where one of the highest places was assigned to him, being that next to the Archbishop of Treves.

He died at his palace at Cawood on December 6, 1315, 9 Edward II., and was buried in the chapel of St. Nicholas in his own cathedral. He had the character of an eloquent man and an able statesman, with a sufficiency of learning: and his library was extensive enough to be worthy of a separate bequest to St. Albans abbey.¹

GULDEFORD, HENRY DE.

JUST. ITIN. 1304. JUST. C. P. 1305.

GURDON, ADAM.

JUST. ITIN. 1280.

ADAM GURDON is mentioned in 16 Henry III., 1231, as one of the bailiffs of Alton in Hampshire.² He died in 38 Henry III., and was the father of the subject of the present notice, who married Custancia, the daughter and heir of John de Venuz, with whom he received extensive lands at Selborne in that county, together with the bailiwick of the king's forests of Wulvermar and Axiholt; paying in March, 1257,

¹ Godwin de Præsul. 685.

² Madox's Exch. ii. 304.

a fine of a mark and a half of gold for the king's confirmation of the grant.¹ Adam seems to have been of a litigious disposition, no less than six entries occurring in the *Abbreviatio Placitorum* of causes decided against him.² He joined the party of De Montford, and even after the battle of Evesham raised an array against his sovereign in Hampshire. Prince Edward advanced against the rebels, and coming up with them between Farnham and Alton he inconsiderately leaped over the trench that surrounded their camp before his forces could follow him. Adam met him, and after a severe fight hand to hand, was at last mastered and obliged to yield himself prisoner to the prince. Edward generously gave him his life, and eventually his liberty, and thus secured the services of a brave and grateful enemy.³

His lands and his office having been restored to him, he built a mansion called the Temple, which overlooked the forest. In 8 Edward I., 1280, Dugdale places him among the justices itinerant in Wiltshire; but the pleas of that iter were confined to the forest, and he was no doubt appointed in virtue of his bailiwick, as he is not mentioned upon any other circuit.

He was frequently summoned to perform military service, and in 23 Edward I. was nominated *custos* of the sea-shores of Hampshire, and a commissioner of array in that county and in Dorset and Wilts.

In 33 Edward I., 1305, he was elected a representative by the "*communitas*" of Scotland, and constituted a justice there; and died in the same year.⁴

Besides his first wife Custancia, already mentioned, he married two others; viz. Almeria, whom he divorced after having two sons; and Agnes, by whom he had a daughter,

¹ Excerpt. e Rot. Fin. ii. 252.

² Abb. Placit. 161, 162. 173. 177. 191. 267.

³ Rapin, iii. 170.

⁴ Rot. Parl. i. 267.; Parl. Writs, i. 161. &c.; Cal. Inquis. p. m., i. 12. 196. 212.

Johanna, to whom he left his property in Selborne, and who married Richard Achard. That estate, still called Gurdon Manor, now belongs to Magdalen College, Oxford.

I conceive that his wife Agnes was the daughter of Simon de Punde, about whose legitimacy there was a suit in 4 Edward I. It is stated that Matilda her mother was never married to Simon, but that he "*aliquo tempore captus fuit per amicos Matildæ in camera fornicando cum ipsa Matilda per quod compellabatur unum de tribus facere vel ipsam affidare vel vitam suam amittere vel ipsam Matildam retro osculare.*" My opinion is founded on the fact that on the decision against Agnes and in favour of Simon's sister, Adam de Gurdon, although not previously mentioned, is recorded as being "in mercy."¹

His representatives still flourish in two families, both descended lineally from his second son Robert: one seated at Assington Hall in Suffolk; and the other at Letton in Norfolk, and Grundisburgh in Suffolk.²

HAMILTON, WILLIAM DE, ARCHDEACON AND DEAN OF YORK.

? JUST. ITIN. 1280. ? KEEPER, 1292. CHANCELLOR, 1304.

WHERE William de Hamilton was born, or who were his parents, is not mentioned; but that he had property in Cambridge appears by his petition to the parliament in 18 Edward I., to grant three messuages there in mortmain to the brothers of Mount Carmel in that city. His name is first recorded as a justice itinerant, but for pleas of the forest only, in Hampshire and Wiltshire in 8 Edward I., 1280, standing last on the list.³ In 10 Edward I., he was *custos* of the bishoprick of Winchester, and of the abbey of Hyde.⁴

¹ Abbrev. Placit. 267.

² Burke's Landed Gentry, i. 514.

³ Dugdale's Chron. Series.

⁴ Abb. Rot. Orig. i. 404.